



EXERCISE · MODULE 5 OF 7

From Correct to Effortless

A hands-on exercise for User experience — take a technically correct “pay my bill” flow and redesign it around what the customer actually feels.

20 min work

5 min present

5 min Q&A

EXERCISE FLOW

Three phases, thirty minutes

01



Redesign

20 min

Small groups walk a real “pay my bill” flow as a customer, measure it, then redesign it around the customer's actual experience.

02



Present

5 min

Two groups present their redesigned flow and the before/after numbers; rest post their work for a gallery walk.

03



Q&A

5 min

The rest of the room questions the presenting groups — every kept step has to survive being challenged.

THE SCENARIO

Hand each group this current flow

A customer opens the app to pay a \$84.12 bill due in 2 days. Walk every screen between opening the app and a confirmed payment.

- 1. Home screen — no bill or balance visible; tap “Account”
- 2. App asks the customer to log in again (session was already active)
- 3. Pick “Billing” out of a 12-item account menu
- 4. Invoice opens as a PDF in a new tab — no inline balance shown
- 5. “Make a payment” redirects to a third-party portal, different branding
- 6. Re-enter the account number by hand — nothing carried over
- 7. Choose a payment method — only bank transfer shown; card is hidden under “more options”
- 8. Tap confirm → “Request submitted.” No amount, no confirmation number, balance unchanged on screen

Every step, on its own, was signed off as “correct.”

WHAT'S HIDDEN

- X 11 taps, ~3.5 minutes, 2 logins
- X One unexplained jump to a third-party domain
- X No confirmation number or receipt
- X No one has ever timed it as a customer

YOUR TASK • 20 MIN • GROUPS OF 3–4

Redesign around the customer's 30 seconds

Work from the Slide 3 flow. Anything you keep has to survive being asked “why does the customer need this step?” in Q&A.

1 Measure it as a customer

Walk the current flow yourselves. Count taps, time it, and mark exactly where confidence breaks down.

2 Redesign the entry point

What's the one thing a customer wants the instant they open the app to pay a bill? Design the home screen around that.

3 Design the feedback loop

What must the customer see before, during, and after paying so they never have to wonder “did that work?”

4 Defend one step you kept

Not everything can be cut. Pick one step you kept and justify it in terms the customer would accept, not internal process.

FACILITATOR RUN SHEET

How to run the room

0:00

Post the current flow (Slide 3) and the four prompts (Slide 4). Form groups of 3–4. Start a visible timer.

0:12

Checkpoint: every group should have counted taps and timed the current flow before they start redesigning.

0:20

Time's up. Two groups present their redesigned flow, 2–2.5 min apiece. Everyone else posts their sketch/doc.

0:25

Open the floor: the rest of the room questions the presenting groups — use Slide 11's prompts if it stalls.

Materials: printed/linked current flow, shared doc or whiteboard per group, visible countdown timer.



MODEL SOLUTION

What effortless actually looks like

The next four slides walk the same bill-pay flow through each prompt, step by step — use them to calibrate groups during Q&A, not to hand out in advance.

STEP 1 OF 4 · MEASURE IT AS A CUSTOMER

Walk your own flow before you defend it

BEFORE

No one on the team had ever paid a bill through their own app as a customer. Every review happened at the level of a single screen, signed off in isolation.

AFTER

Taps to pay: 11
Time to pay: ~3.5 minutes
Logins required: 2
Domain switches: 1 (unexplained)
Confirmation shown: none

Why it matters: You can't design for a feeling you haven't measured. Counting taps and timing the flow turns “it feels clunky” into numbers everyone can rally around cutting.

STEP 2 OF 4 · REDESIGN THE ENTRY POINT

Put the customer's next action where they land

BEFORE

Home screen shows account tiles and a promo banner. “Pay bill” is 3 taps deep, behind “Account” and a 12-item “Billing” menu — organized by the org chart, not the customer's intent.

AFTER

Home screen leads with: “\$84.12 due Oct 3 — Pay now.” Amount and due date are visible the instant the app opens. One tap starts payment with the account already selected.

Why it matters: The customer opened the app to do one thing. Surfacing it removes 3 taps of navigation before any redesign of the payment flow itself even begins.

STEP 3 OF 4 · DESIGN THE FEEDBACK LOOP

Never let the customer wonder “did that work?”

BEFORE

Before paying: no visible total. During: a redirect to an unbranded third-party page with no progress indicator. After: “Request submitted” — no amount, no confirmation number, balance on screen unchanged.

AFTER

Before: amount, method, and account shown together on one screen. During: an in-app processing state (“Confirming with your bank...”). After: a confirmation number, the balance updates on screen immediately, and a receipt is emailed.

Why it matters: Confidence comes from visible state, not correctness the customer can't see. The system can be right and still feel broken if nothing shows it.

STEP 4 OF 4 · DEFEND ONE STEP YOU KEPT

Cutting friction isn't the same as cutting safeguards

BEFORE

Every step was flattened to the same priority, so teams either stripped out real fraud checks to hit a tap-count target, or kept a full re-login “just in case” with no stated reason.

AFTER

Kept: one lightweight re-auth (biometric or PIN) immediately before submitting payment — a real fraud-prevention control. Cut: the earlier, redundant full login that checked nothing new. Framed to the customer as “Confirm it's you to pay,” one tap.

Why it matters: A defensible flow names why each remaining step exists, in terms the customer would accept — not “that's our process.” That's what survives Q&A.

Q&A · 5 MIN

Three questions worth asking any presenter

1

How many taps and seconds, really?

Ask presenters to name their new numbers, not just describe the redesign.

2

What did you cut, and why was it safe to cut?

Separates thoughtful simplification from accidentally removing a safeguard.

3

How would the customer know it worked?

Checks whether the feedback loop — not just the happy path — got redesigned too.

The pattern: the customer never sees your architecture — they only see whether the thing they came to do got easier or harder.



UP NEXT

Module 6: Measuring what customers feel

Keep today's redesigned flow — you'll define the metrics that catch a regression in it before a customer does, next session.